

Setup Guide

Introduction to Data Science 2026

Throughout the course, we will use the following software:

R: The programming language that we will use, aimed at statistical computing.

RStudio: An integrated-development Environment (IDE). IDEs bundle a lot of functionality that make programming easier into a single software. We will use it to write and execute our R code, generate plots, bundle code and written text into reports,...

git: A version control system that allows you to store code in a scalable way, share your code with others and collaborate easier with others on the same codebase.

We will also use a **terminal**, which is a way to write commands for your computer to execute, rather than telling it what to do via clicking, as you are probably used to.

Below I will provide instructions on how to install these on *Windows*, *macOS*, and *Linux* systems.

Please follow these instructions before attending the R bootcamp on 05./06.09 and before the first lab sessions (second week of classes) at the latest. If you get stuck, AI assistants are surprisingly helpful in figuring out setup-related issues. You can also write to me at l.hagemann@hertie-school.org.

Installing R

Windows: Download the installer from [here](#) and execute it.

macOS: [This site](#) lists the installer for different types of machines. Which one you need depends on whether your laptop has Apple Silicon or an Intel CPU.

Linux: Usually, the R repository will already be available via your package manager. Install R like you install your other software. Alternatively, you can download packages from [here](#).

Installing RStudio

Installers/packages for all platforms are available on the [official website](#). Please note, that it is necessary to install **both R and RStudio** explicitly.

Installing git

The official [git homepage](#) describes how to install git on all major operating systems.¹

Please also create a [GitHub](#) Account if you don't have one yet.

On Windows and macOS you might also install [GitHub Desktop](#).²

Terminals

If you are using macOS or Linux, your Operating System already shipped with a Terminal that is sufficient for everything we will need during the course.

If you are using Windows, you might want to [install the Windows Subsystem for Linux \(WSL\)](#), which allows you to run a Linux shell on Windows. While this is not strictly necessary, doing it now ensures you don't to stress about it later during the course.

¹ If you are using macOS, now might be a good time to consider using [homebrew](#). Alternatively, I recommend the XCode method described as the third option on the linked site.

² If you are using Linux, but are not comfortable using the Command Line, please write an e-mail to l.hagemann@hertie-school.org.